

TUTORIAL

How to Do a Magic Ring in Crochet: Step-by-Step Tutorial

The closed-centre starting technique behind nearly every amigurumi, hat, and round project on this site.

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The magic ring, sometimes called a magic circle, is how most round crochet projects begin. It creates a fully closed centre with no gap, which is why it's used to start our [amigurumi ball pattern](#), [beanie pattern](#), and [coasters pattern](#), among many others on the site.

What you need

- Any hook and yarn (practising with worsted-weight yarn and a 5.0mm hook is easiest to see)
- A few minutes to practise the motion before starting a real project

Making the ring

Steps

1. Cross the yarn to form a loop, with the tail end lying behind the working yarn (the strand connected to the skein). Hold the crossing point between your thumb and finger.
2. Insert your hook through the centre of the loop, from front to back.
3. Yarn over and pull up a loop through the centre of the ring, bringing it back through to the front. You now have one loop on your hook, sitting inside the ring.
4. Chain 1. This chain doesn't count as a stitch — it just secures the ring before you begin.

 Yarn crossed into a loop for a magic ring

Working stitches into the ring

Steps

1. Insert your hook through the centre of the ring (not into a specific stitch, just through the open loop), and work your first stitch as the pattern instructs (usually single crochet).

2. Continue working the required number of stitches through the centre of the ring, one after another. You'll see them stacking around the outer strand of the loop.
3. Once all stitches are worked, you'll have two loose ends: the tail (short end) and the outer ring strand.

Closing the ring

Steps

1. Hold your stitches in place, and firmly pull the short tail end (not the working yarn). The outer loop will shrink and pull the stitches into a tight, closed circle.
2. Slip stitch into the first stitch of the round to join, if your pattern is worked in joined rounds, or place a stitch marker and continue in a spiral if working continuously (see our [amigurumi for beginners guide](#) for more on spiral rounds).

Frequently asked questions

What is a magic ring in crochet used for?

A magic ring is the starting point for most projects worked in rounds, especially amigurumi, hats, and coasters. It creates a fully closed centre with no hole, unlike starting with a chain.

Why won't my magic ring tighten all the way?

This usually means the yarn tail wasn't pulled after the first round of stitches was worked into the loop. Pull the short tail firmly, not the working yarn, and the centre should close completely.

Can I use a chain instead of a magic ring?

Yes, a small starting chain joined into a ring is a common substitute and slightly easier for some beginners, though it leaves a small hole at the centre that a magic ring avoids.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.